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Unit 6 Expanding Knowledge on the Topic

PDF Documents

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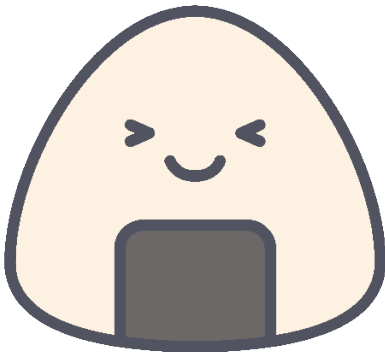
Emojis Around the World: A Cultural Exploration

Did you know the same emoji can mean different things around the world? This fascinating twist adds color to our digital conversations, showing how diverse cultures shape our emoji usage.

Smiles and Gestures

A smiley 😊 might convey politeness in Japan, not just happiness.

And be careful with that thumbs-up 👍—it's not friendly everywhere!



Food for Thought

Emojis aren't just about emotions; they include a variety of objects, like food.

The rice ball 🍡 is a common snack in Japan and carries a sense of comfort and familiarity there. But outside of Japan, people might be less familiar with it, using it more for its visual appeal than its culinary significance.

Animal Symbolism

Animal emojis also carry diverse meanings. The owl 🦉, for example, is often associated with wisdom in Western cultures. However, in some other cultures, it might be seen as a bad omen. Similarly, the frog 🐸 might just be a cute amphibian to some, but in Japan, it's associated with good luck and safe travel because of the word "kaeru," which means both "frog" and "return."



Embracing Emoji Etiquette

As our world becomes more interconnected, understanding the cultural contexts of emojis can enhance our digital communication, making it more inclusive and empathetic. So, the next time you choose an emoji, consider its wider meanings. It's a small step towards embracing our global digital community, one emoji at a time. 👥

